DAY 31 | PRE-READ

Keeping AI Running Day After Day

A light read before Day 31. About 15 minutes, no code required.

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Why read this?

Building an AI feature is the exciting part. Keeping it working every day, for thousands of users, is where most of the real work happens. This week is about running AI in production, and tomorrow also covers the human side: raising problems well and staying calm under pressure.

1. A car needs servicing

Buying a car is not the end; it needs fuel, servicing and repairs, and its value changes over time. AI applications are similar. The model provider updates models, users ask new kinds of questions, costs change. Running AI reliably is called **LLMOps**.

2. How AI apps break

Problem	Everyday comparison
Too many requests at once (rate limits)	A shop that only lets 50 people in at a time
The AI provider is slow or down	A supplier who does not deliver on time
The model changes behaviour after an update	A favourite restaurant changes its chef
Costs suddenly jump	A phone bill that doubles because an app kept running

Good systems expect these problems: they try again sensibly, switch to a backup, and tell users clearly when something is wrong.

3. Raising the alarm well

When something breaks, the way you tell people matters. A clear message says what is wrong, who is affected, what you have tried, what you need and when you will update next. Japanese workplaces call this habit **hou-ren-sou**: report, inform, consult.

4. Emotional intelligence

Incidents are stressful. Customers may be angry and colleagues tired. **Emotional intelligence** is noticing feelings, your own and others', and responding in a way that helps. It is often what separates a good engineer from a trusted one.

Key idea: calm, clear communication during a problem builds more trust than never having problems.

5. About tomorrow's assessment

Day 32 includes a 1.5 hour assessment on Weeks 5 and 6: GenAI, RAG, agents, security and evaluation. Review those post-reads this week.

6. Think about these before class

- Recall a time a service you rely on failed. How did the company communicate? What would you have wanted?
- How do you notice when you are getting stressed at work?
- Write the first sentence you would send your manager if your project's demo broke one hour before a customer meeting.

Hou-ren-sou (報連相): report, inform, consult